

## Preface

**W**hen I graduated from college, I didn't know what a W-4 was, nor did I know what I was doing when I filled one out. My ignorance was not limited to tax forms; I had no idea what a 401(k) was, didn't have a clue how health insurance worked, and couldn't understand the terms of my student loans, which I had agreed to when I was seventeen years old. Because I assumed everyone else knew these things, I hid my ignorance and adopted a fake-it-till-you-make-it approach. While I succeeded in faking it, I never made it.

Tired of being constantly broke and in debt, I decided to read everything I could on personal finance, and I came to a couple conclusions. First, it is absurd that this is not taught to every high schooler in America. While AP European History or transcendental poetry may come in handy for some students, basic finance is going to shape the future of every student. Second, this stuff is not particularly difficult to understand. I went into this thinking you had to be a genius or math whiz to understand these concepts, but this is not the case. Third, I realized I was not alone! As I studied personal finance, I began speaking with my friends and colleagues and discovered nearly all of them were as poorly